



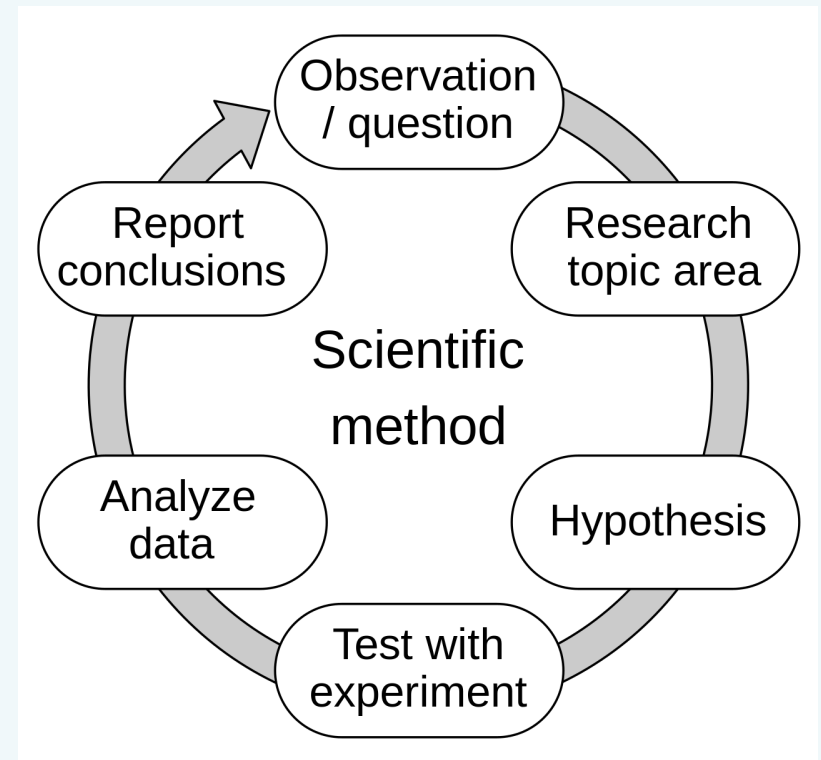
Observation and Inference in the Scientific Method

I can...

- ✓ use my senses to make detailed observations. [1.1.1]
- ✓ use observations and prior knowledge to make inferences about the natural world and communicate my reasoning. [1.1.2]
- ✓ explain the difference between inference, observation, and opinion. [1.1.3]

What is the Scientific Method?

-- a way of learning about reality by forming, testing and modifying a **hypothesis** through systematic **experimentation**, **observation** and **measurement**. Data are analyzed and **conclusions** are shared with and checked by other scientists with similar interests.

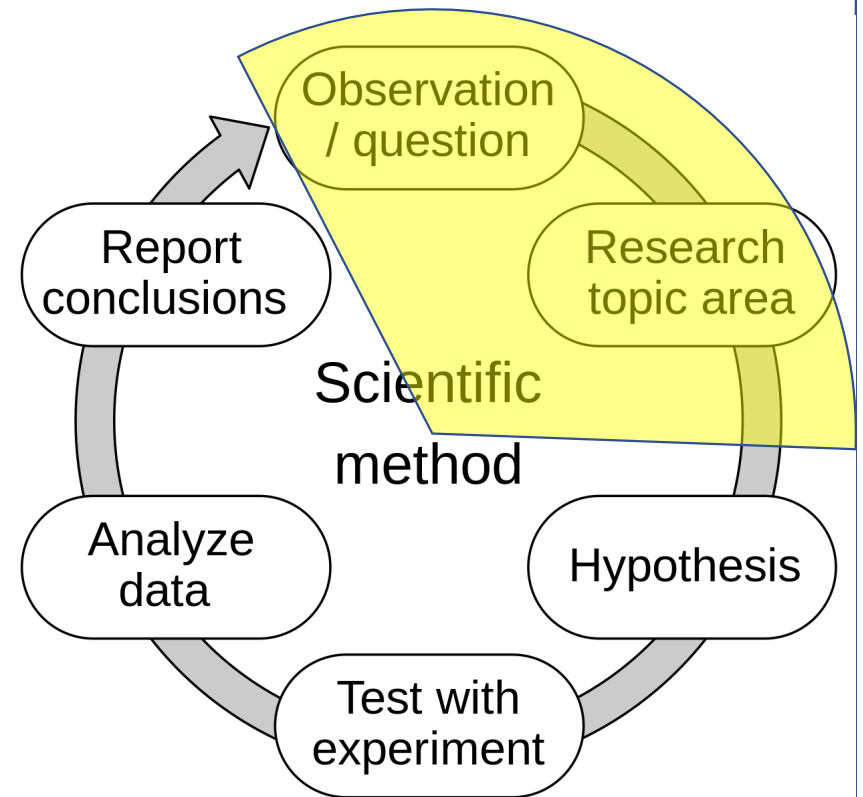


What is the Scientific Method?

-- a way of learning about reality by forming a question that can be **tested**.

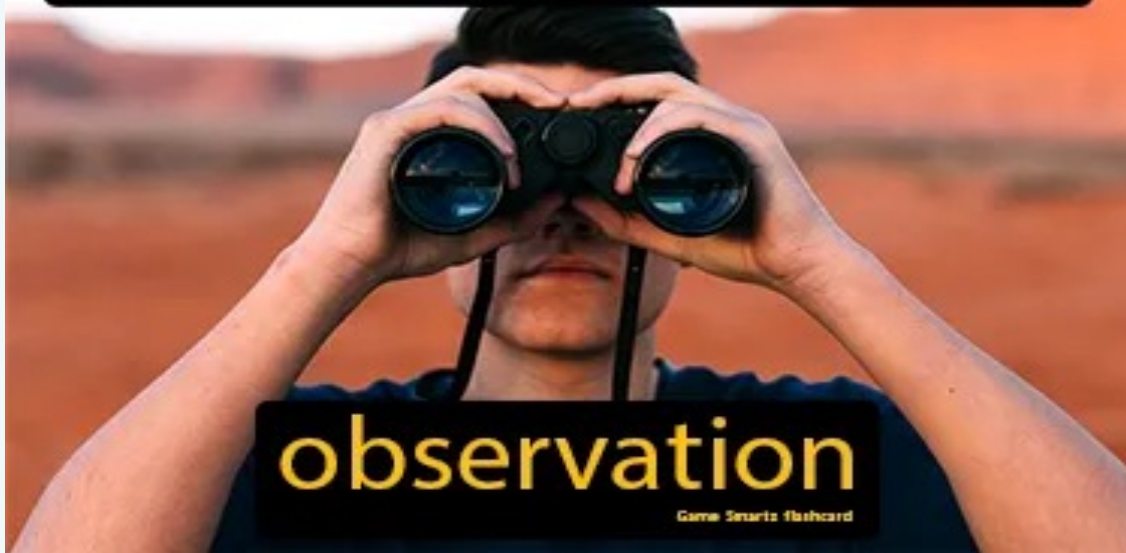
How can we form a scientific (testable) question?

Making observations, using previous knowledge, and researching help us think of good questions.



Vocabulary

the process of using your senses to gather information



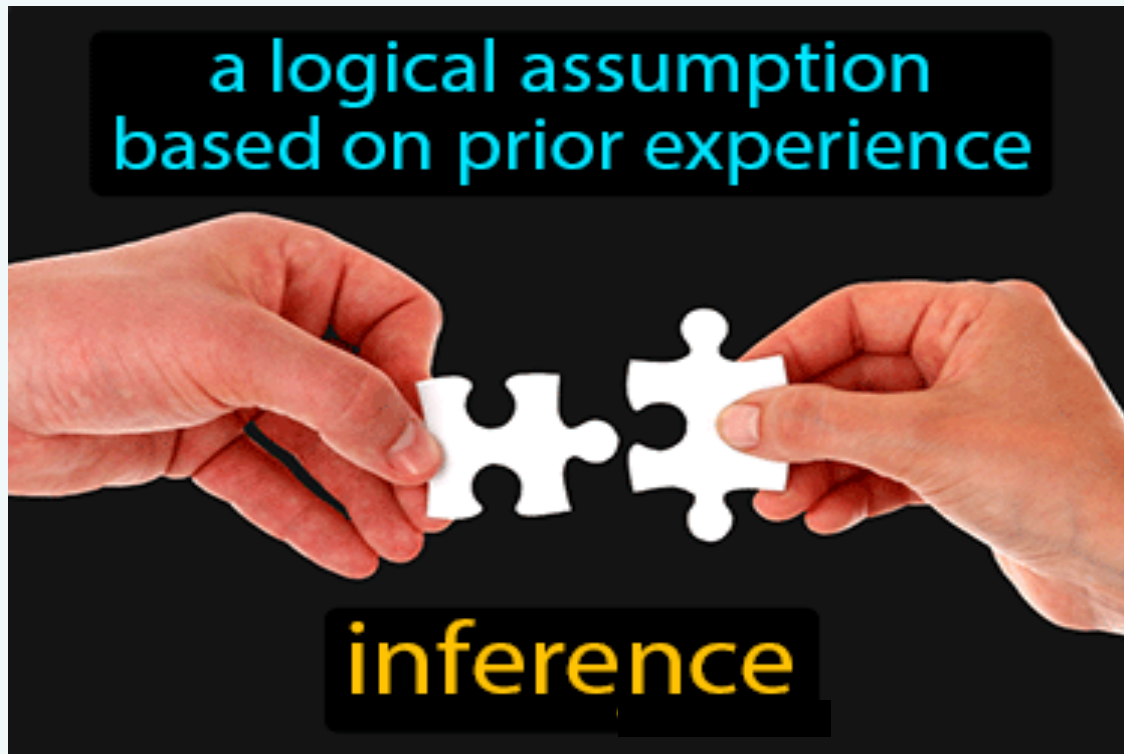
observation

Game Starts flashcard

Think & Talk

1. What kinds of things can we observe?
2. Is there anything we can't observe?
3. How can technology help with observation?
4. As scientists, what do we do when making an observation?

Vocabulary



Think & Talk

1. What do you make inferences about in daily life?
2. What knowledge and experience do you use to make inferences?
3. As scientists, where do we find useful background knowledge?